

ARLINGTON COUNTY
AUDIT COMMITTEE CHARTER
Adopted: July 21, 2015
Amended: October 21, 2025

I. Audit Committee Purpose, Duties, and Responsibilities

- A.** The Audit Committee (Committee) has been established by the County Board (Board) to provide advice to the Board regarding the exposure of Arlington County government and its component units to risk, such as financial, operational, and reputational risks. In fulfilling its responsibilities, the Committee coordinates closely with the Office of County Auditor (OCA) to promote the integrity and effectiveness of the audit process.
- B.** The creation of the Audit Committee is not intended to materially alter the responsibility and authority of either the County Board, OCA, or the County Manager.
- C.** The Committee's primary duties and responsibilities may include:
 - i.** Reviewing OCA's draft annual audit plan, and providing suggestions and comments to the County Auditor for consideration to be included in the audit work plan that is submitted to the County Board for approval;
 - ii.** Receiving issued audit reports from the OCA and reviewing the results with the County Auditor;
 - iii.** Receiving and reviewing the OCA's semi-annual reports on follow-up regarding audit recommendations and corrective action taken by management;
 - iv.** Receiving an annual report from the OCA summarizing information such as audits completed, major findings, corrective actions taken and follow up audits' status;
 - v.** Providing feedback to the County Manager on resources needed to support the OCA in advance of the proposed budget;
 - vi.** Upholding the independence of the OCA;
 - vii.** Determining, jointly with the County Auditor, the nonpartisan objective group to provide peer review of the OCA;
 - viii.** Evaluating the findings and recommendations of the OCA's peer review as required by recognized government auditing standards;
 - ix.** Receiving an annual report from the County's external auditor on the results of the financial statement audit;
 - x.** Receiving an annual update regarding the results of the County's Internal Audit work;
 - xi.** Providing feedback on the performance assessment of the County Auditor as requested by the County Board, for the purpose of completing the Board's annual performance review of the County Auditor;
 - xii.** Maintaining confidentiality as required by law;
 - xiii.** Annually reviewing the Audit Committee Charter to determine if revisions are needed; and

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- xiv.** Reporting to the County Board or Board members on concerns relating to the duties and responsibilities outlined herein at such times as deemed appropriate.

II. Audit Committee Composition, Appointment, and Meetings

A. Composition, terms, and experience

i. The Committee shall consist of eight members

1. Two (2) County Board members
2. County Manager and the Director of the Department of Management and Finance
3. One Board-appointed member from the Fiscal Affairs Advisory Commission, who will serve in an ex officio role
4. Three (3) Community members

ii. Terms

1. Community member appointments will be for a two-year term and are to be staggered so that no more than two terms expire in a single year.
2. Except in rare circumstances, Community members are limited to six years on the Audit Committee.

iii. Experience

1. Minimum: Community members shall have appropriate experience, such as performance auditing, risk advisory services (including enterprise risk management), public sector knowledge, or financial literacy.
2. Desired: Experience in public administration, audit committees, or boards with governance or financial stewardship responsibilities.

B. Appointment

- i.** The members of the Committee shall be appointed by the Board. Members serve at the pleasure of the County Board.
- ii.** The Two County Board members will serve as co-chairs.

C. Meetings

- i.** The Committee shall meet as needed to perform its duties but shall not meet less than once quarterly.

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- ii. Meetings will be open to the public and conducted in accordance with the public meeting requirements of the Freedom of Information Act, §§2.2-3700 et seq. of the Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended.
- iii. Meeting agenda items shall be posted on the Arlington County Audit Committee website in advance of each meeting to ensure Audit Committee members and the public have the opportunity to review them.
- iv. Meeting attendance shall be in accordance with the Audit Committee's Virtual Meetings and Remote Participation in Meetings Policy.
- v. The Committee may request that the County Manager direct staff to attend a Committee meeting or meet with Committee members or consultants to discuss management's corrective action plans in response to audit findings.